

1 – REFLECT

Theme: Parenting During the Teen Transition Years

Core Thought: “Your teen doesn’t need a perfect parent; they need a present one.”

Quick Facts:

- The adolescent brain undergoes its second major developmental phase between ages 13–19.
- 1 in 7 teens experiences a diagnosable mental health issue.
- Regular parental engagement reduces risky teen behavior by up to 40% (UNICEF report).

Reflection Prompt:

When my teen seems withdrawn or resistant, do I react, retreat, or reach out?



2 – RELATE

Analogy: Parenting a Teen is Like Gardening You can’t pull the plant to make it grow faster—you can only nurture the soil, water it regularly, and protect it from harsh weather. Growth happens quietly but surely when the environment is right.

Mini-Story:

A mother once said, “My son stopped sharing things when I started solving instead of listening.” The day she began asking, “Tell me more,” he began talking again.

Quick Tool – The 3Cs of Teen Connection:

1. Calm: Take a breath before responding.
2. Curiosity: Ask questions, don’t assume.
3. Consistency: Be predictable—emotionally and behaviourally. Teens find safety in that.



3. REFRAME



Parent Self-Plotting Sheet:

Rate yourself from 1 (rarely) to 5 (often):
I listen without interrupting: _ _ _

I acknowledge effort, not just results: _ _ _
I express warmth through small rituals: _ _ _
I give my teen space but stay available: _ _ _
I manage my reactions consciously: _ _ _

Weekly Practice:

Choose one “C” (Calm, Curiosity, or Consistency) to strengthen this week. Journal your experience in a few lines.

Inspiration Quote:

“Your children need your presence more than your presents.”
— Jesse Jackson

Next Step:

Watch out for Episode 4 — Understanding the Teen Mindset: Why They Don’t Think Like Adults (Yet!)